Manual 8: Across the desks

For everybody who works the marquee, and whoever trains them

Most exceptions start at one desk and finish at another. This manual follows each case from the runner's first step to the line in the record, desk by desk, so that the person tearing the slip and the person scanning the bag do the same case the same way.

The desks, and what each one may do

desk	who	may do	may not do
Goody bag table	volunteers with phones (Manuals 3-5)	hand over a bag against two scans, or against a slip	hand over a bag on a promise, a name or a number said out loud
Exception desk	one person at the registration PC (Manual 6)	find a registration, tear and log a slip, decide a case with the registrant	hand over bags
Late entry and payment desk	the race office, with the cash tin	take payment, issue a receipt, sort out entries with no race number	tear slips
Race office (the PC)	whoever runs the desk (Manuals 1 and 2)	watch the alerts, declare that scanning has stopped, export	change a handover
Timekeeper	the RaceClocker laptop	upload the start list the race office exports	

> ***A bag leaves the table against two scans, or against a slip the exception desk tore and logged. There is no third way.***

In every case below the last column says what lands in the record. That is how a case is checked on Sunday morning.

Part A: Paper authorisations

A1. Cannot open the email

The commonest case. The runner has a code somewhere, but not in their hand: a flat phone, a deleted email, a letter that went to their partner.

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Asks for the code; there is none. Sends them to the exception desk at the far end.	nothing
2	exception desk	desk	Types the race number or surname, **Find the slip**. Checks the person against the names.	nothing
3	exception desk	desk	Tears the slip off the sheet the page names, presses **Slip torn off and handed over**.	slip_issued, with the time
4	table	volunteer	**Bag only**, types a race number off the slip, scans each bag, taps tab 2.	checkin_bypass [slip N], Email Scan Bypassed = Y
5	table	volunteer	Keeps the slip.	the slip itself

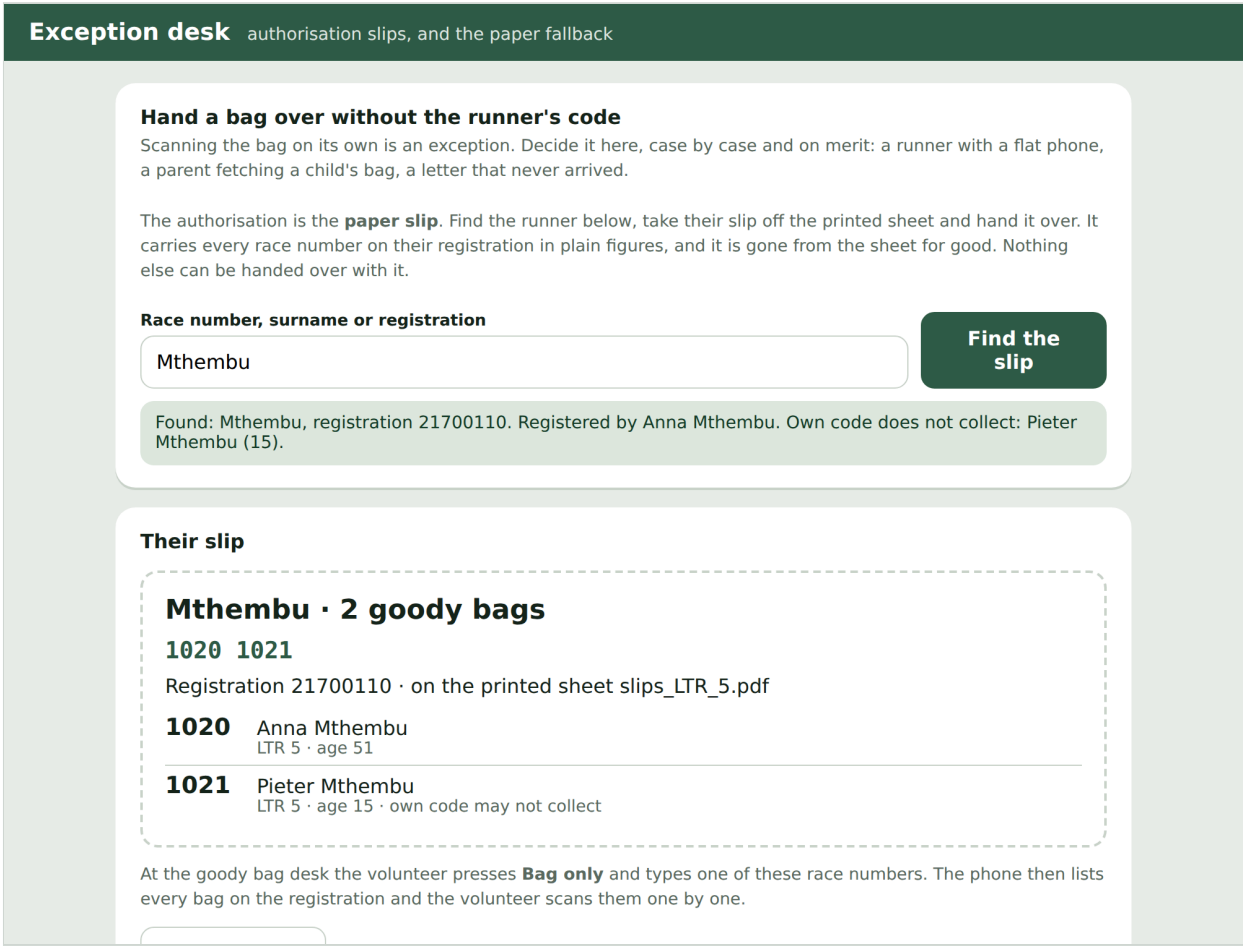


Figure 1. *Step 2: found by surname; the page says which printed sheet the slip is on.*

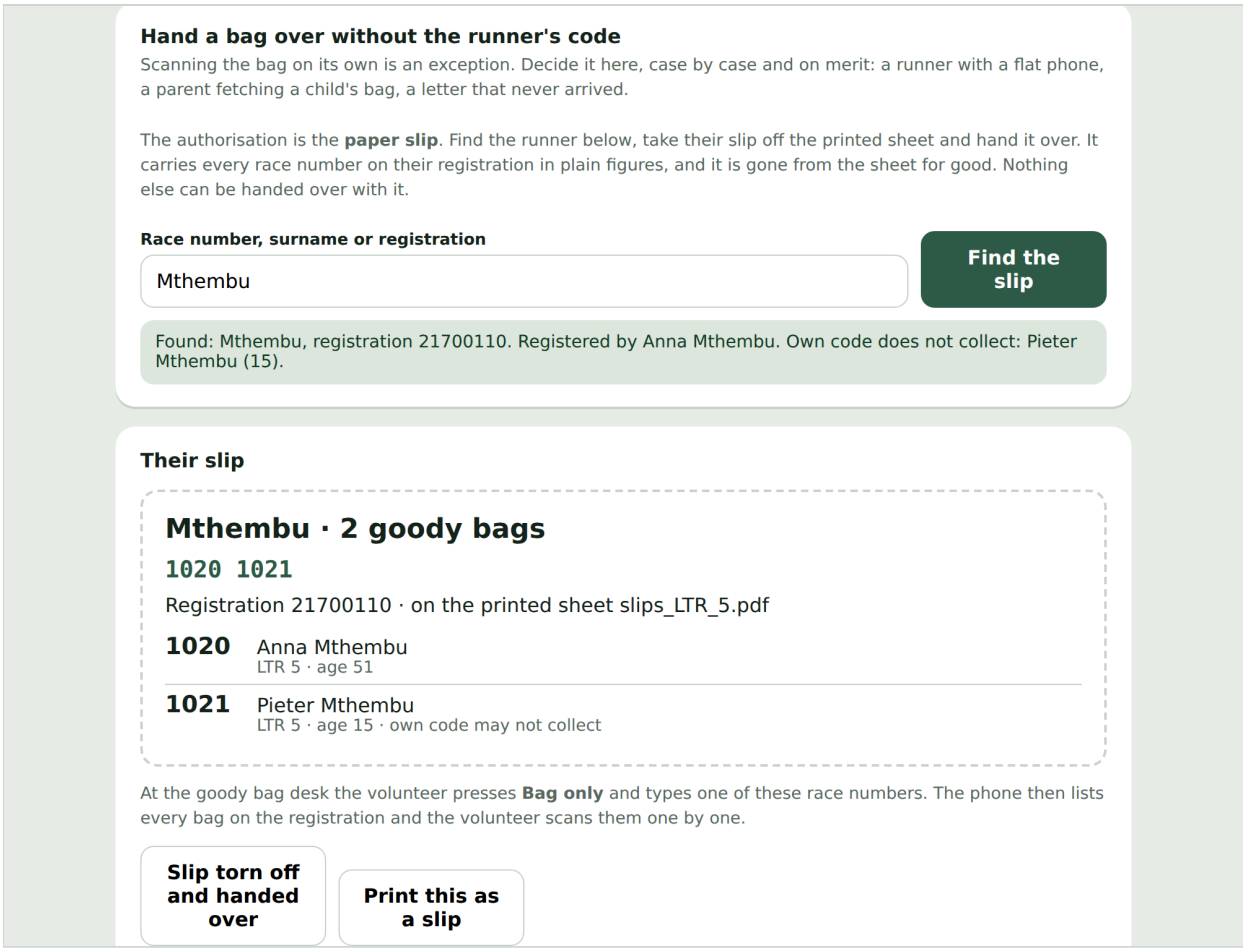


Figure 2. *Step 3: the tear is logged.*



Figure 3. *Step 4: the phone asks for a number off the slip.*

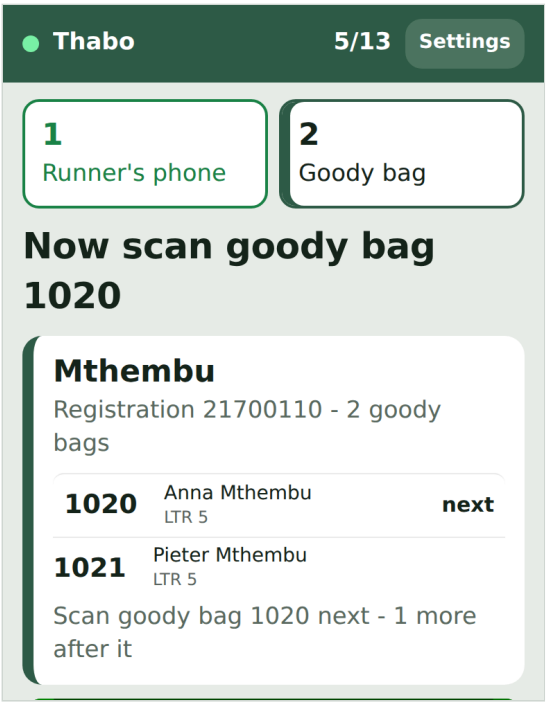


Figure 4. *One number opens every bag on the slip.*

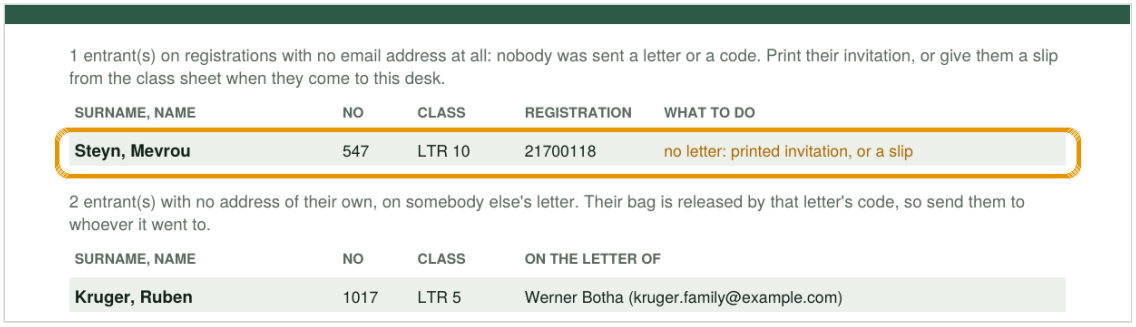


Figure 5. *Step 4, done: every bag on the slip, recorded as a bypass against it.*

A2. Nobody in the family has an email address

step	where	who	does	record
1	before the race	race office	Alert 18 names them; part 5 of the exception desk sheet lists them. Prints their invitation if a Word letter is set.	alert 18 in the log

step	where	who	does	record
2	exception desk	desk	Finds them. Hands over the printed invitation if there is one; otherwise follows A1, steps 3 to 5.	slip_issued, or nothing if the invitation is used
3	table	volunteer	Invitation: scans it like a phone (Manual 3). Slip: Bag only (A1, step 4).	checkin, or checkin_bypass [slip N]



1 entrant(s) on registrations with no email address at all: nobody was sent a letter or a code. Print their invitation, or give them a slip from the class sheet when they come to this desk.

SURNAME, NAME	NO	CLASS	REGISTRATION	WHAT TO DO
Steyn, Mevrou	547	LTR 10	21700118	no letter: printed invitation, or a slip

2 entrant(s) with no address of their own, on somebody else's letter. Their bag is released by that letter's code, so send them to whoever it went to.

SURNAME, NAME	NO	CLASS	ON THE LETTER OF
Kruger, Ruben	1017	LTR 5	Werner Botha (kruger.family@example.com)

Figure 6. *Part 5 of the exception desk sheet: the registrations with no address at all, first.*

A3. A family across classes, no phone

As A1, but the slip is on *slips_across_classes.pdf*, not on a class sheet. The page says so; the table does nothing different.

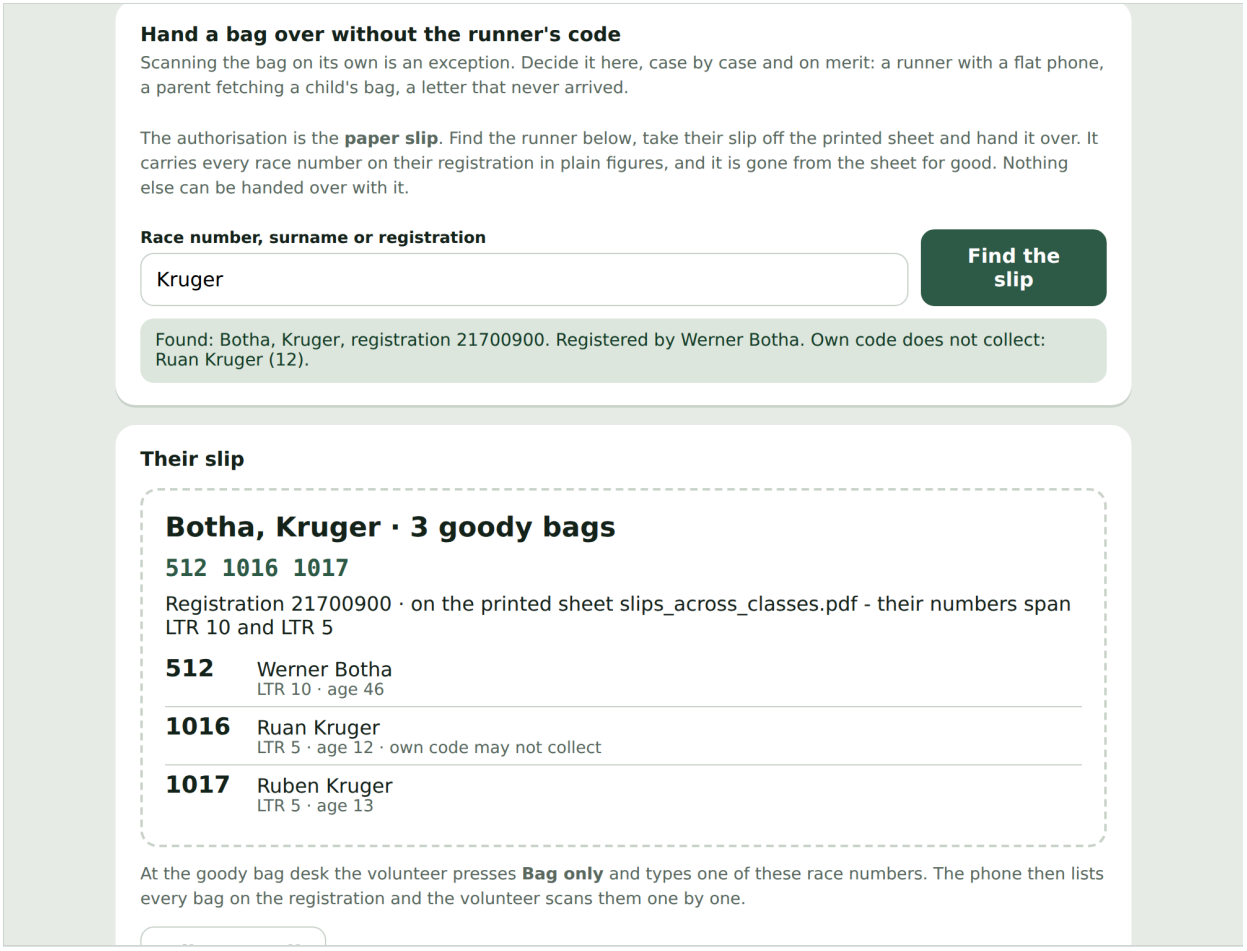


Figure 7. *The page names the sheet.*

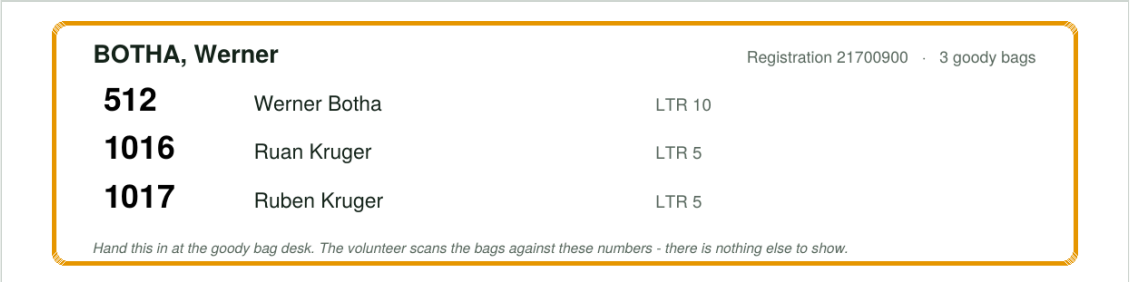


Figure 8. *The slip: every bag, in both classes.*

A4. A friend collects (option 3, chosen before the race)

step	where	who	does	record
1	before the race	registrant	Replies 3 with the friend's name and race number; or the race office enters it by hand (Manual 1).	Choices sheet in collection_choices.xlsx
2	before the race	race office	Slims again. The friend's slip is printed in part 1 of the exception desk sheet; the family's slip is left off the class sheets.	Delegate column
3	exception desk	desk	Types the family's surname. The page names the friend. Checks the friend's race number or ID. Tears the pre-printed slip, logs it.	slip_issued
4	table	volunteer	Bag only, types a number from the bag lines (not the friend's own number), scans the bag.	checkin_bypass [slip N]
5	table	volunteer	The friend's own bag: their own code, the ordinary way.	checkin

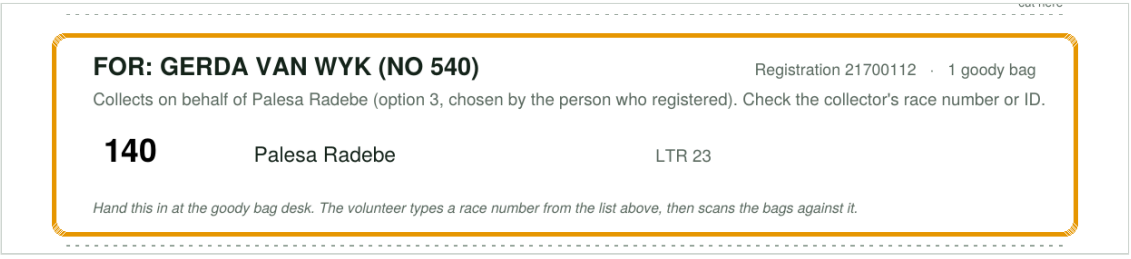


Figure 9. *The pre-printed slip.*

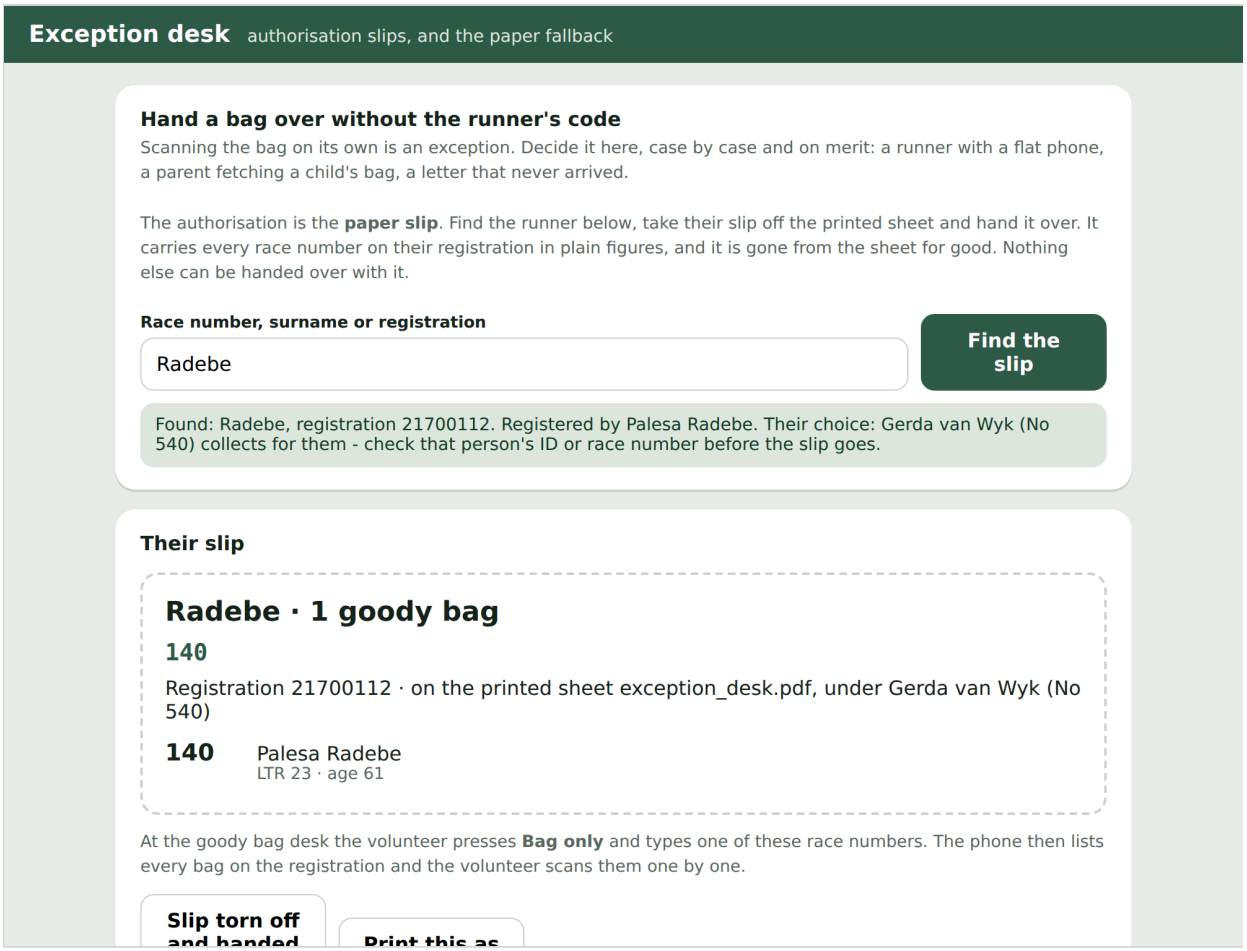


Figure 10. *The page: the family's choice, and where the slip is.*



Figure 11. *The family's bag, handed to the friend against the slip.*

A5. A child alone; the parent agrees by phone

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Scans the child's code: **This code may not collect**. Next runner. Sends the child to the exception desk.	nothing (the PC refused it too)

step	where	who	does	record
2	exception desk	desk	Finds the family. Part 3 of the sheet and the page say who collects instead.	nothing
3	exception desk	desk	Phones the person who registered. Only if they agree: tears the family's slip, writes on it who it went to and who agreed, logs it.	slip_issued
4	table	volunteer	Bag only, types a number off the slip, scans each bag.	checkin_bypass [slip N]

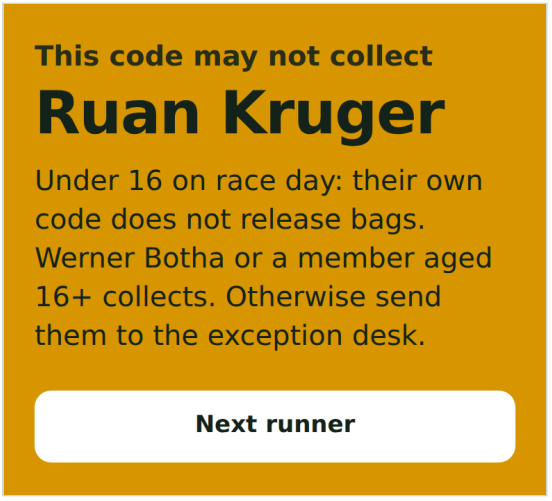


Figure 12. *Step 1, at the table.*

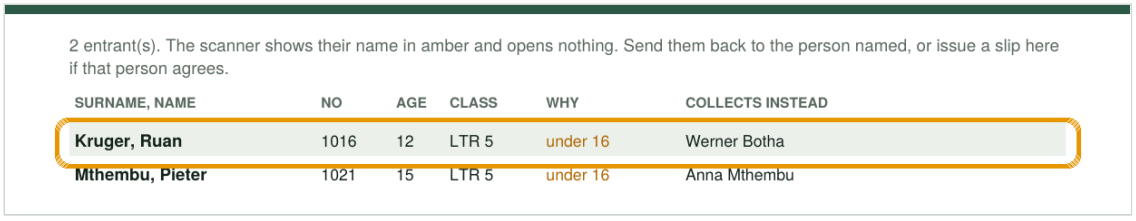


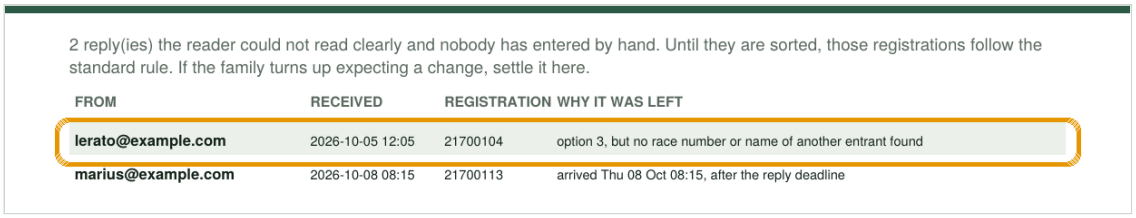
Figure 13. *Step 2, on the sheet: who collects instead.*

If the parent does not agree, or cannot be reached, the child waits for them. Nothing is torn.

A6. A change on the day

A family whose reply was late or unclear (part 4 of the sheet), or who never replied, wants somebody else to collect.

step	where	who	does	record
1	exception desk	desk	Finds the family. Confirms the change with the person who registered: in person, or on the phone.	nothing
2	exception desk	desk	Tears the family's slip, writes the named person on it, logs it.	slip_issued
3	table	volunteer	Bag only, as A1, for the person holding the slip.	checkin_bypass [slip N]



2 reply(ies) the reader could not read clearly and nobody has entered by hand. Until they are sorted, those registrations follow the standard rule. If the family turns up expecting a change, settle it here.

FROM	RECEIVED	REGISTRATION	WHY IT WAS LEFT
lerato@example.com	2026-10-05 12:05	21700104	option 3, but no race number or name of another entrant found
marius@example.com	2026-10-08 08:15	21700113	arrived Thu 08 Oct 08:15, after the reply deadline

Figure 14. *Part 4 of the sheet: the replies nobody could settle before the race.*

Part B: When the table sends someone back

B1. The slip and the bag do not match

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Tab 2 goes amber: the bag is not on this slip. Does not tap; puts the bag back in its own place.	nothing
2	table	volunteer	Fetches a bag that is on the slip. If none of the slip's bags is on the table, sends the runner back to the desk with the slip.	nothing
3	exception desk	desk	Checks the slip against the page. A wrong slip is a desk mistake: it is noted on the slip and the right one found.	a second slip_issued if a new slip is torn

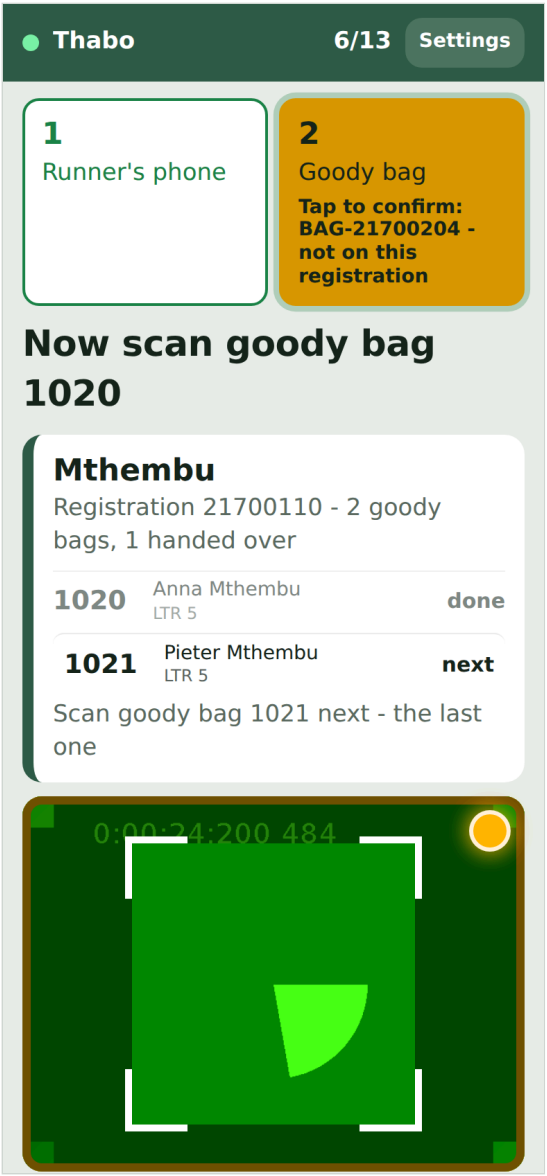


Figure 15. *The amber tab.*

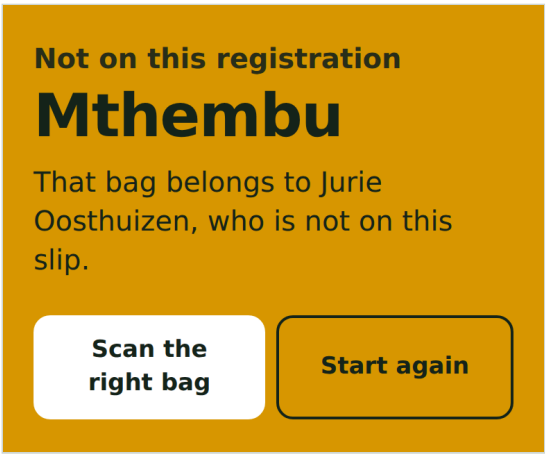


Figure 16. *If tapped: refused by name, with whose bag it is.*

B2. A number that is on no slip

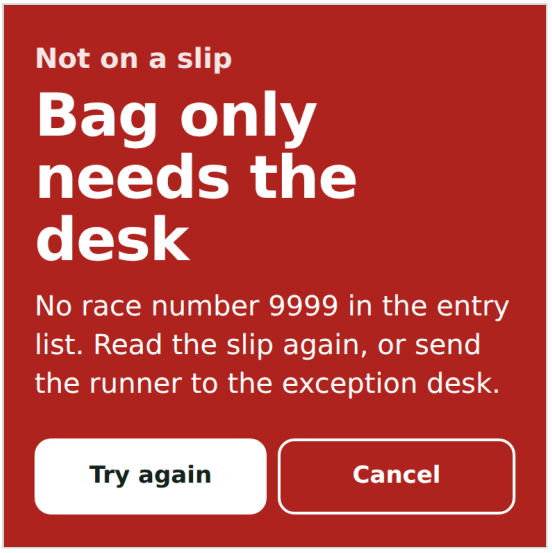


Figure 17. *A typed number on no slip: refused, with no way past it at the table.*

The volunteer sends the runner back to the exception desk with the slip. Usually it is a typo; the desk reads the slip again, or the number was copied by hand and the person never had a slip at all.

B3. A slip brought back

The same slip, after its bags were handed over: the phone says every bag on it is already handed over. Next runner. If the runner insists, the exception desk looks up the record: who handed what over, and when.

B4. Not fully paid

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Tab amber, then **Not fully paid**. Presses **Skip, next runner**. The queue does not stop.	nothing
2	payment desk	race office	Takes payment, writes a receipt.	the cash book
3	table	volunteer	Scans the runner again, **Paid at desk, hand over**, scans the bag.	checkin_override; on the start list, and named in the export as paid at the desk

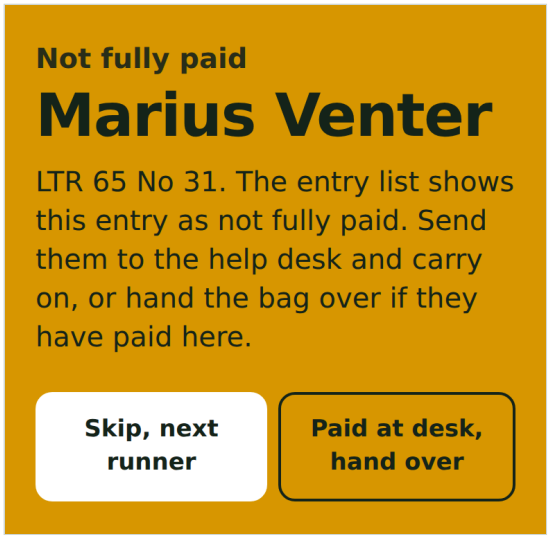


Figure 18. Step 1.

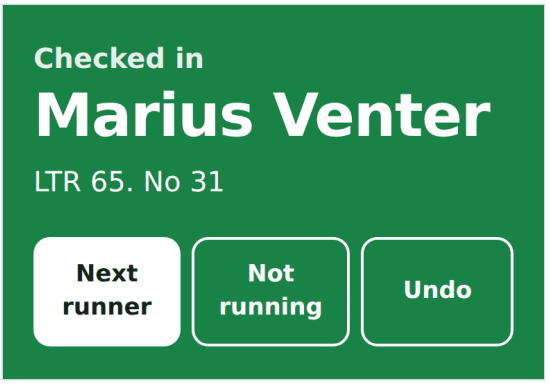


Figure 19. Step 3: handed over with the override.

B5. No race number yet

step	where	who	does	record
1	before the race	race office	Alert 14 names them; their letter says to see the organisers first.	alert 14
2	late entry desk	race office	Sorts the entry out: payment, a number.	EntryNinja, and the race office's list
3	table	nobody	There is no bag on the table for them until the race office has dealt with them; the race office hands their bag over and adds them to the timekeeper's list itself.	the race office's list

Part C: After the bag

C1. Took the bag, not running

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Scans the runner: Already collected. Presses **Not running**.	Not Starting = Y
2	race office	race office	The next export leaves them off the start list and names them.	the export log
3	timekeeper	timekeeper	Uploads the start list. They are not waited for on the mountain.	RaceClocker

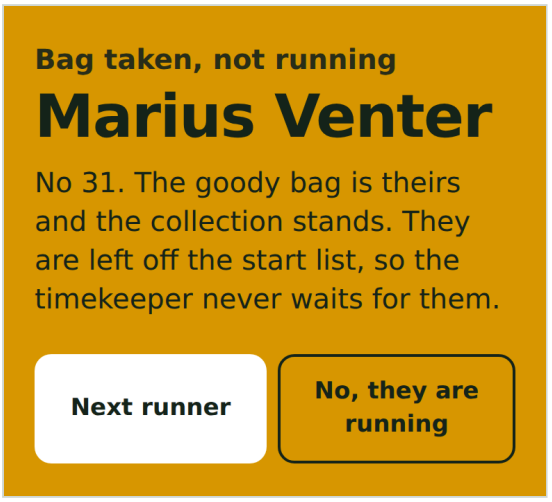


Figure 20. *Step 1. The bag is still theirs; only the start list changes.*

Somebody who collects and then falls ill overnight is not caught by any of this: the gate count at the start is what catches them.

Part D: When the equipment fails

D1. The Wi-Fi drops

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Scan bag anyway; the phone saves the check-in with its real time.	on the phone
2	race office	race office	The light on the wall is red. Checks the PC and the router.	nothing
3	table	phone	When the Wi-Fi returns, the saved check-ins go to the PC by themselves.	checkin, with the time it happened

D2. A phone dies with check-ins on it

step	where	who	does	record
1	table	volunteer	Charges the phone; opens the same browser; **Show queued scans**.	on the dead phone
2	table	another volunteer	Settings, **Recover scans from another phone**, scans each code.	checkin_recovered
3	table	volunteer	Clears the old phone only after it asks twice.	



Figure 21. *Steps 1 and 2.*

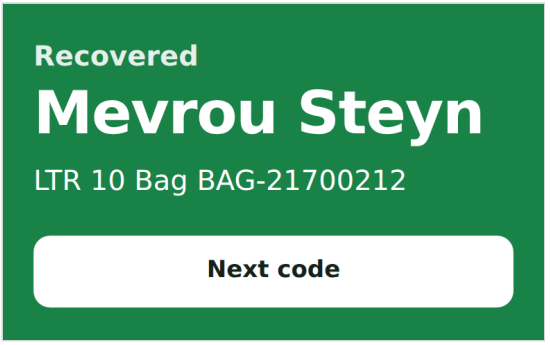


Figure 22.

D3. Scanning stops altogether

step	where	who	does	record
1	exception desk	desk	Types what happened, presses **Scanning has stopped**. Nobody else may.	fallback_on, with the reason
2	table	volunteers	Hand over against the printed collection lists, ticking names.	the ticked lists
3	table	one person	Walks the table with the table-walk app. Red banner: the walk is now the record.	ON THE TABLE lines
4	exception desk	desk	**Everyone else collected their bag**, once the walk is complete: on the PC's own browser, or on the walker's phone with the desk PIN.	everyone not on the table recorded as collected
5	exception desk	desk	**Scanning works again**, if it does.	fallback_off

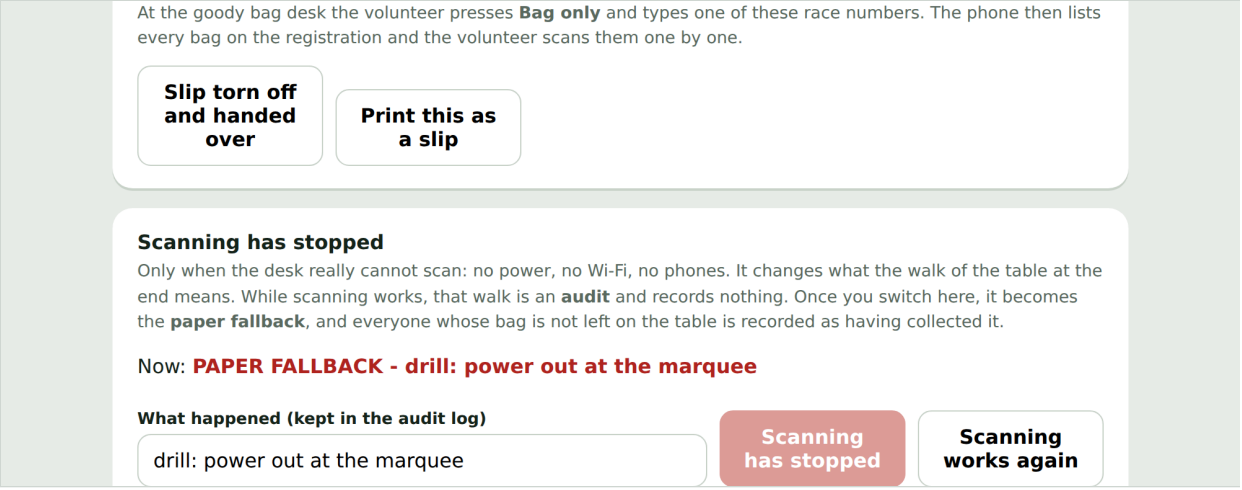


Figure 23. *Step 1, at the desk.*

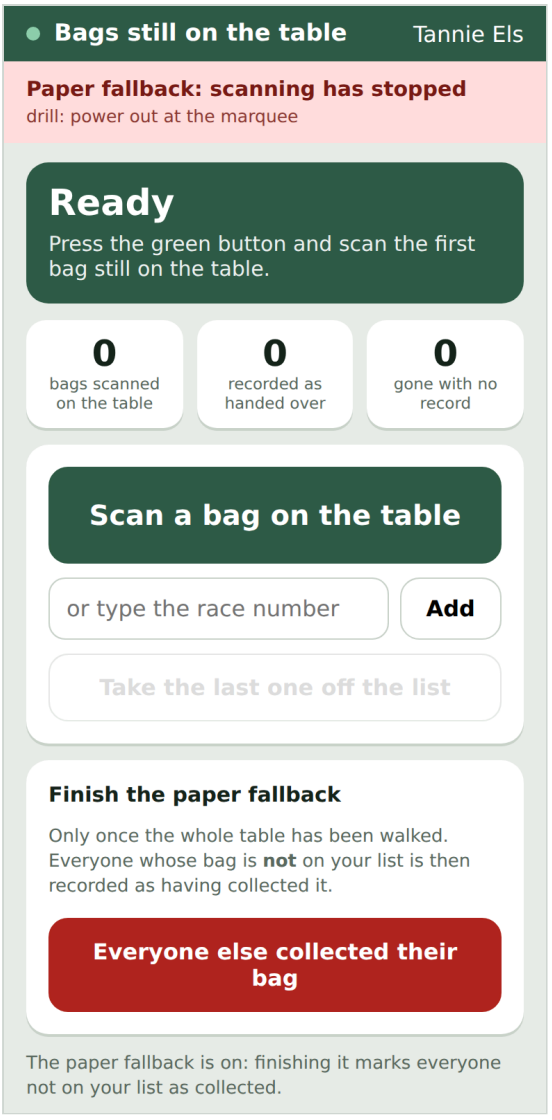


Figure 24. *Step 3, on the walker's phone.*

Part E: Rehearse it together

The rehearsal pack (Manual 1, section 6) prints every case in this manual on real entries. Rows 1 and 2 of each page are ordinary handovers; row 3 a screen exception; row 4 a paper exception, and every paper row says what the **exception desk** does first, then what the **table** does.

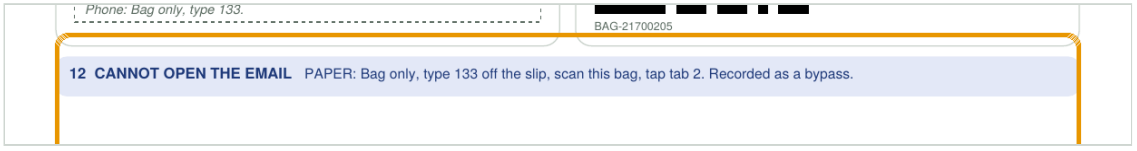


Figure 25. *A paper row: the desk's step (find, which sheet, tear, log) and the phone's step (Bag only, type the number) on the same slip.*

1. Put the exception desk at its own table with the PC, the slip sheets and the exception desk sheet. Start the rehearsal server.
2. One person plays the runners, carrying the rehearsal pack.
3. For a paper row, the runner goes to the desk first; the desk does its step and hands over the slip; the runner goes to the table; the volunteer does the phone step.
4. Compare each screen with the band under the row. Anything different goes to the race office before race day.
5. Afterwards, clear nothing: the rehearsal server kept its own record, apart from the race-day one.